

GitHub Two-Account SSH Workflow Cheat Sheet

Accounts

AccountA: Admin - creates/owns private repos, reviews PRs

AccountB: Contributor - writes code, pushes branches, raises PRs

Step 1: Generate SSH Keys

```
$ ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "accountA@example.com" -f ~/.ssh/id_ed25519_accountA
```

```
$ ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "accountB@example.com" -f ~/.ssh/id_ed25519_accountB
```

Optional: Set a passphrase for added security

Step 2: Add Public Keys to GitHub

```
$ cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519_accountA.pub
```

```
$ cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519_accountB.pub
```

Add the output to each GitHub account under Settings > SSH and GPG keys

Step 3: Configure ~/.ssh/config

```
Host github-accountA
```

```
  HostName github.com
```

```
  User git
```

```
  IdentityFile ~/.ssh/id_ed25519_accountA
```

```
  IdentitiesOnly yes
```

```
Host github-accountB
```

```
  HostName github.com
```

```
  User git
```

```
  IdentityFile ~/.ssh/id_ed25519_accountB
```

```
  IdentitiesOnly yes
```

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Step 4: Test SSH Setup

```
$ ssh -T git@github-accountA
```

```
$ ssh -T git@github-accountB
```

Step 5: Clone Repo Using AccountB

```
$ git clone git@github-accountB:AccountA/repo-name.git
```

```
$ cd repo-name
```

```
$ git config user.name "AccountB Name"
```

```
$ git config user.email "accountB@example.com"
```

Step 6: Work as Contributor (AccountB)

```
$ git checkout -b feature/cool-feature
```

```
# make changes
```

```
$ git add .
```

```
$ git commit -m "Add cool feature"
```

```
$ git push origin feature/cool-feature
```

Then open a Pull Request on GitHub

Optional Step 7: Forks and Multiple Remotes

```
$ git clone git@github-accountB:AccountB/repo-name.git
```

```
$ cd repo-name
```

```
$ git remote add upstream git@github-accountA:AccountA/repo-name.git
```

```
$ git fetch upstream
```

```
$ git merge upstream/main
```

Bonus: Check Git Identity in Any Repo

```
$ git config user.name
```

```
$ git config user.email
```